Explanation (36)



14. Asia has enormous reserves of coal, amounting to nearly three-fifths of the world's total, but they are unevenly distributed. The largest reserves are found in Siberia, the Central Asian republics, India, and especially China; Indonesia, Japan, and North Korea have smaller but nevertheless economically important reserves. China has chiefly high-grade coal reserves. Every province has at least one coalfield, but the largest reserves are in Shanxi and Shaanxi in the Ordos River basin in the north. Sichuan, Shandong, and the Northeast are old coal-producing regions with good reserves, and a coal-mining area with large deposits has been developed in central Anhui, north of the Yangtze River (Chang Jiang).
15. Reserves of uranium ore are found in Asia's ancient crystalline rocks. The richest ore fields are found in Kyrgyzstan, between Osh